

ENDICOTT COLLEGE

FactSet Financial Concepts

BUS209 • Course Syllabus • Fall 2026

COURSE NUMBER	BUS209	FACULTY	Bethany Evitts, CFA — Assistant Professor
COURSE TITLE	FactSet Financial Concepts (FFC)	OFFICE	Gerrish 356
CREDITS	1	TELEPHONE	617-877-2001 (text accessible)
CLASS TYPE	Lecture / discussion / presentation / FactSet certification videos	EMAIL	bevitts@endicott.edu
SEMESTER	Fall 2026	OFFICE HOURS	See electronic calendar

Course Overview

FactSet Financial Concepts (FFC) introduces the characteristics of four core areas of finance. The core areas covered are Economic Indicators, Currencies, Fixed Income, and Equities. The sections are woven together from FactSet data, news, and analytics. Students, individually or in small groups, will make class presentations using the FactSet terminal on at least one topic covered in each section.

Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Explain how investors use economic indicators to gauge the health of the economy.
- Explain the qualities of good economic indicators.
- Identify the three main drivers of currency valuation.
- Demonstrate how investors and businesses are affected by currency markets and how they manage currency risk.
- Describe how yields facilitate comparison across the vast diversity of the bond market.
- Interpret the meaning of the four major shifts in the yield curve and the meaning of curve inversion.
- Calculate equity index performance from the performance of single stocks.
- Identify the three types of relative valuation and the role of future earnings growth when assessing fair value.

Teaching & Learning Strategies

Course sessions include lecture, group discussions, and hands-on FactSet terminal exercises, both in class and for homework.

In addition to the in-class sessions, it is your duty to regularly—at least once per day—check your email and Canvas to ensure you understand what you are expected to complete for this class.

It is in your best interest to keep up with assignments. Please contact me with questions about the content. I am here to help. If you find any concepts unclear, let me know and let me help you. I want you to do your best in this course.

Readings & Materials

- FactSet modules in video form.
- FactSet Certificate programs, free for students who access learning information through the FactSet app/web pages.
- Required: FactSet Desktop Application and Microsoft Office 365.

Evaluation Methods

Student learning will be assessed through the following. Core section deliverables and presentations account for 80%; FactSet Certifications account for 10%; and logistics, timeliness, preparedness, attendance, and participation account for 10%.

Assessment	Weight
Country Economic Indicators & Markets	20%
Equities / Pitch Book	20%
Credit Analysis Presentation	20%
Final Presentation	20%
FactSet Certifications	10%
Attendance / Participation	10%

Grading

Each student will be assigned a letter grade as follows:

Grade	Range	Grade	Range
A	94–100	A–	90–93
B+	87–89	B	84–86
B–	80–83	C+	77–79
C	74–76	C–	70–73
D+	67–69	D	64–66
D–	60–63	F	< 60
WX	Withdrawn Failed		

Course Policies

Academic Integrity Policy

Students are required to abide by the Academic Integrity Policy of Endicott College.

AI Policy

Students are required to abide by the AI Policy of Endicott College, and violations are subject to the college's Academic Integrity Policy. Instructor course policy to be finalized: include any course-wide policies, procedures for using and citing AI use, and the penalty for violations.

Attendance Policy

Students are required to abide by the Attendance Policy of Endicott College. Attendance in this course is required, including the last day of scheduled classes in the semester and the final exam. Students who fail to attend 3 class meetings will be dismissed from this course. If you are absent due to an athletic contest, please have the appropriate paperwork completed in a timely fashion (before the game). You will not be permitted to miss class for workouts or practice.

Turnitin Policy

By taking this course, students agree that all required assignments may be subject to submission for 'similarity review' to Turnitin.com, a tool intended not just to detect instances of plagiarism, but to prevent it as well. The tool is intended to help students identify passages that are unoriginal, incorrectly cited, or lacking appropriate source information. Submitted assignments may also be archived in the Turnitin.com database for checking possible future instances of plagiarism, additional similarity searches, and other educational purposes at the discretion of the instructor. For more information, please review the Privacy and Security guide at Turnitin.com.

Student Support

Accessibility Services

Endicott College provides equal educational opportunities for all students regardless of disability status. If you believe that you qualify as a person with a disability as defined by Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) of 1990 and its Amendment Act of 2008 (ADAAA), you are encouraged to register with the Center for Accessibility Services Office to request accommodations, auxiliary aides, and/or support. The Center for Accessibility Services is located on the 2nd Floor of the Diane M. Halle Library. Please visit the Center for Accessibility Services website and contact access@endicott.edu with questions.

Academic Support

The Division of Academic Success believes that every student can benefit from having a thought partner who supports their learning. We offer innovative and individualized services that motivate you as you pursue your educational goals.

Content and Writing Tutoring

Work with content tutors who can help you understand, remember, and apply course content, or with writing tutors who will support your growth as writers and thinkers. Students can schedule free tutoring sessions on TutorTrac or stop by Halle Library 204.

Quick-Connect Coaching

Meet with a professional academic coach for thirty minutes to devise a solution to an immediate challenge, including unpacking a difficult assignment, creating a specific study schedule for an upcoming assessment, prioritizing multiple responsibilities, and more. Students can schedule free quick-connect sessions on TutorTrac or stop by Halle Library 204.

Academic Coaching

Grow your academic self-awareness and deepen your connection to your education by partnering once, twice, or three times a week with a professional academic coach to develop academic confidence, resilience, and grit; develop

time-management and organizational systems and strategies; learn how to set and adjust goals; and recognize how best to use resources. This program has an additional cost. To enroll, email academiccoaching@endicott.edu.

Workshops

Semester workshops help students build skills in crucial areas for learning and succeeding: time management, goal setting, note-taking strategies, and metacognition. See the website for a complete list of programs.

Title IX 2024 Policy

Institutions cannot discriminate based on a student's pregnancy or parental status—past or present—or any related conditions, medical or otherwise. Qualified students may be eligible for academic adjustments enabling them to continue their academic process. For more information about Title IX protections regarding pregnancy or parental status, contact Endicott's Title IX Officer, Christy Galatis, at cgalatis@endicott.edu, (978) 998-7746, or www.endicott.edu/title-ix.

Course Expectations

For each credit hour, students are expected to spend a minimum of two hours on work outside of class each week. For this one-credit course, that means a minimum of two hours each week.

Students must review the online Academic Calendar published by the Registrar's Office:

<https://www.endicott.edu/academics/academic-resources-support/academic-calendar/undergraduate> (the original syllabus also referenced <http://tinyurl.com/hbmfwj>).

Class attendance is expected of all students up to and including the last day of scheduled finals in the semester. Students must plan accordingly.

Instructor template note retained from the 2025 syllabus: Modify the credit/hours sentence above as needed. Additional course expectations may be added to this section.

Topic Outline & Timeline

The table below is a rough guide to the topics and activities in this course. Starting in Week 1, you have something due almost every week. Any schedule changes will be announced via Canvas; log in at least once per day to check announcements and keep pace with assignments.

Week	Week of	Assignments Due / Weekly Class Topics
1	September 14	Introductions & FactSet Certification Expectations; FactSet login; Company Scavenger Hunt
2	September 21	Exploring the Markets with FactSet; Economic Indicators; assignment of Economic Indicators topics
3	September 28	Economic Indicator Discussion; Wealth Management: News & Market Performance
4	October 5	Economic Indicator Presentation
5	October 12	No Class — Indigenous Peoples/Columbus Day (observed)
6	October 19	Equity Market; Equity Research; Accounting and Company Information
7	October 26	Equity Market Industry Analysis and ESG
8	November 2	Equity Presentations
9	November 9	Fixed Income — Introduction & Credit Analysis
10	November 16	No Class (instructor-planned; confirm in Canvas)
11	November 23	No Class — Thanksgiving recess

Week	Week of	Assignments Due / Weekly Class Topics
12	November 30	Fixed Income Market Presentations
13	December 7	FactSet Financial Concepts Final Paper and Presentation
14	Finals week: December 14–18	FactSet Financial Concepts Certifications

Subject to Change Statement

The syllabus sets forth my course objectives and my best estimate of what we will be able to cover during the semester. To tailor the course to the specific needs of the students, I might modify the syllabus during the semester; for this reason, it is possible that not all material will be covered and/or that additional material may be assigned.